



[Figure 14-1:](#) A physical Tower of Hanoi puzzle set

Solving this puzzle is a common computer science problem used for teaching recursive algorithms. Our program won't solve this puzzle; rather, it will present the puzzle to a human player to solve. You'll find more information about the Tower of Hanoi at

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tower_of_Hanoi.

The Output

The Tower of Hanoi program displays the towers as ASCII art by using text characters to represent the disks. It might look primitive compared to modern apps, but this approach keeps the implementation simple, because we only need `print()` and `input()` calls to interact with the user. When you run the program, the output will look something like the following. The text the player enters is in bold.

THE TOWER OF HANOI, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com

Move the tower of disks, one disk at a time, to another tower. Larger disks cannot rest on top of a smaller disk.

More info at https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tower_of_Hanoi